

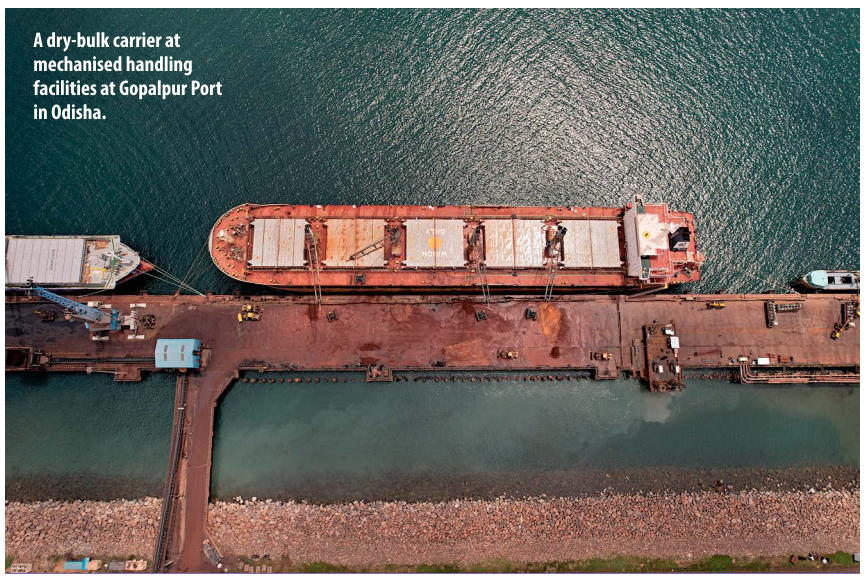
WHY PARADIP IS A BIG PORT WIN FOR APSEZ

The 30-year concession adds 18 million tonnes of mechanised dry-bulk capacity and gives the country's largest port operator a stronger foothold in the industrial heartland of eastern India

For Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ), emerging as the highest bidder for a 30-year concession to develop and operate two berths at Paradip Port is about more than adding capacity. It gives India's largest port operator a strategic presence at one of the country's most important bulk cargo gateways and strengthens its position along the East Coast.

The project will add 18 million metric tonnes (MMT) of mechanised dry-bulk handling capacity, taking APSEZ's total portfolio from 653 MMT to 671 MMT. It also brings Paradip, India's second-largest major port, into a network that already has a substantial presence along the eastern seaboard.

The significance of the concession lies in what it adds to that network. Paradip is not an isolated gateway. It sits close to some of eastern India's most important mineral and industrial belts, giving APSEZ a stronger link between major cargo-producing regions and the wider national logistics network.



A dry-bulk carrier at mechanised handling facilities at Gopalpur Port in Odisha.

A stronger position on the East Coast

APSEZ's existing East Coast portfolio includes Haldia in West Bengal, Dhamra and Gopalpur in Odisha, and Gangavaram in Andhra Pradesh. These ports account for more than 140 MMT of capacity. The Paradip concession further strengthens the company's access to a mineral-rich hinterland spanning eastern and central India.

That hinterland is central to the commercial opportunity. Odisha and neighbouring states are home to major steel, power, mining and manufacturing activity, creating sustained demand for the movement of raw materials. Coal, limestone and other dry-bulk commodities move through this industrial corridor, while finished products and other cargoes travel in the opposite direction.

Paradip's location therefore gives APSEZ another important gateway into a region where cargo generation is closely linked to industrial activity. It also gives customers greater choice in moving cargo through a network rather than relying on a single port.

The two berths will be developed with state-of-the-art mechanised cargo-handling systems, deep-draft facilities and large-scale storage infrastructure. For high-volume bulk cargo, these capabilities can support efficient vessel handling and the movement of raw materials between the port and industrial hinterland.

This is particularly relevant as cargo demand continues to rise along the East Coast. High utilisation across the region, supported by expansion in the steel sector and the government's push for domestic coal, is increasing the need for handling capacity. Additional infrastructure at a major bulk gateway can help ease pressure on existing facilities while supporting industries that depend on the steady movement of raw materials.

For APSEZ, the value also comes from network density. A larger spread of gateways allows the company to serve cargo owners through multiple locations, creating greater flexibility as trade flows change. This becomes increasingly important as APSEZ develops an integrated transport platform spanning ports, logistics and inland infrastructure.

A step towards a pan-India logistics network

The Paradip concession fits into APSEZ's broader evolution from a port operator into an integrated transport utility. With the addition, its network will grow to 16 ports and terminals across India's 11,000-km coastline, strengthening its ability to connect cargo origins, ports and inland markets.